

Monthly Market Insights

April 2025

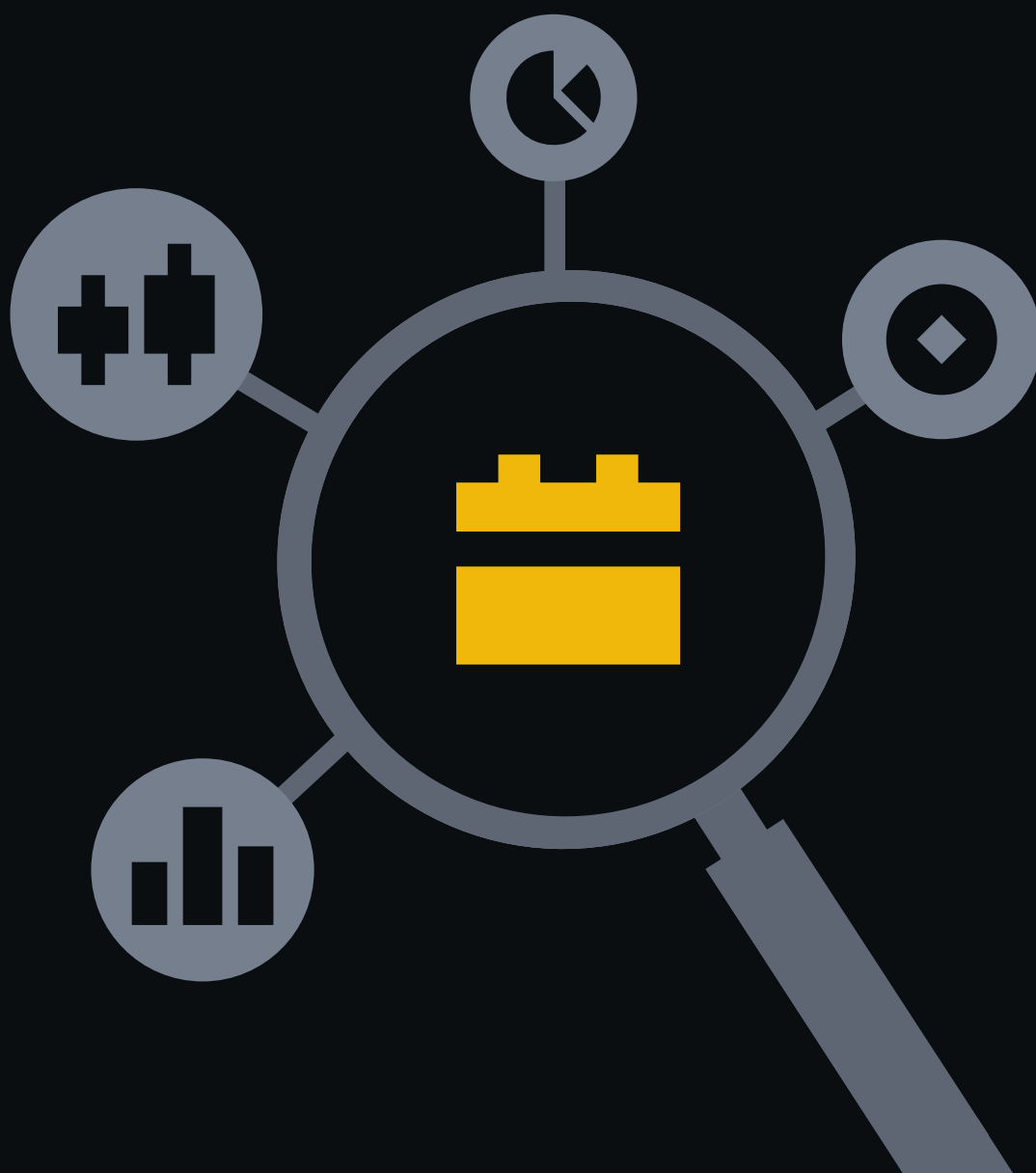


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01 / Key Takeaways

- In March 2025, the crypto market declined by 4.4%, amid volatility following President Trump's Executive Order to establish a Strategic Bitcoin Reserve, and ongoing uncertainty around Federal Reserve rate policy. Renewed tariff tensions — opposed by Canada and Mexico — also contributed to a US\$1B crypto liquidation in cryptocurrency derivative markets on March 4. Meanwhile, regulatory progress — with the GENIUS Act advancing and the OCC approving bank-held crypto — signaled growing mainstream adoption.
- The supply of Bitcoin (BTC) held by long-term holders is on the rise, coinciding with significant adoption marked by the establishment of a U.S. strategic Bitcoin reserve and increased institutional purchases. Bitcoin's on-chain ecosystem has also progressed, with Bitcoin DeFi (BTCFi) experiencing a 2,767% surge in total value locked (TVL) over the past year. These developments, along with potential interest rate cuts, may reinforce positive sentiment for Bitcoin in the medium and long term.
- Strong competition has upended the status quo in the decentralized exchange (DEX) landscape. Uniswap, traditionally the leading DEX, has seen its market share decline significantly, from 45% last year to 29% as of March 2025. Competitors like PancakeSwap and Raydium have been gaining ground, benefiting from robust ecosystem growth and strategic initiatives.
- March brought major shifts in the Web3 wallet landscape, with market share of Binance Wallet surpassing 50% following OKX's temporary suspension of its DEX aggregator services. While this incident seems to have prompted a wave of user migration, the growth of Binance Wallet was also supported by ecosystem activity on BNB Chain, along with the rollout of new features and incentives.
- Pump.fun, the launchpad synonymous with the "memecoin supercycle" on Solana, has seen a significant decline in weekly usage metrics since the launch of \$TRUMP, with total volume, token creation, and active wallets dropping by 69.9%, 51.8% and 45.1%, respectively from their peaks in January 2025.

02 / Crypto Market Performance

In March 2025, the cryptocurrency market cap experienced a decrease of 4.4%, demonstrating a continuation of its pullback from the prior month. Macroeconomic uncertainty, driven by the U.S. Federal Reserve's decision to hold benchmark interest rates steady for a second consecutive meeting, kept risk appetite subdued. This decision reflected concerns regarding persistent inflation, compounded by the unpredictability of new tariffs imposed by President Trump, which continued to inject volatility across global markets.

Towards the end of March 2025, renewed concerns over tariffs surfaced when Canada and Mexico publicly opposed the 25% tariffs that had been in effect since March 4. This backlash intensified market uncertainty and subsequently triggered a significant US\$1B liquidation event within the cryptocurrency derivative market.

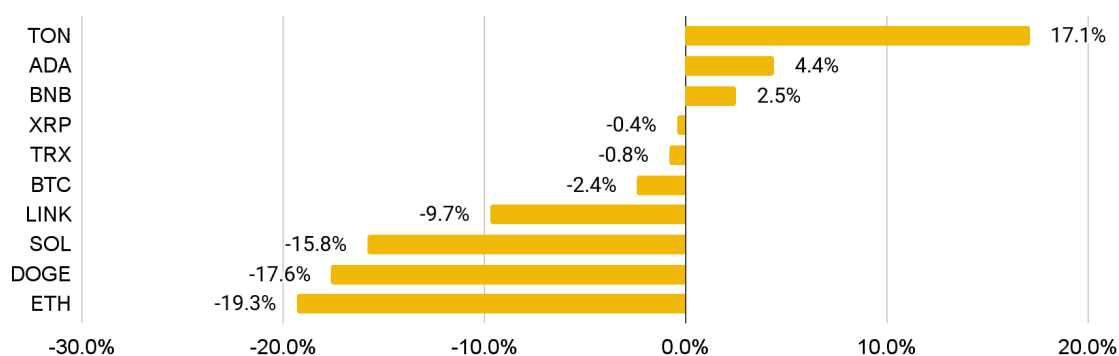
However, March also brought meaningful progress on the regulatory front. The GENIUS Act moved closer to enactment after successfully passing the Senate Banking Committee with bipartisan support. Furthermore, the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC) issued formal guidance authorizing banks to hold cryptocurrencies. Together, these developments indicate a clear trend toward mainstream adoption and deeper integration of digital assets into the traditional financial system.

Figure 1: Monthly crypto market capitalization decreased by 4.4% in March

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2025	4.3	-20.2	-4.4									
2024	0.4	40.0	16.3	-11.3	8.6	-11.4	5.6	-12.4	8.0	2.8	39.9	-4.5
2023	30.4	3.4	9.3	3.2	-6.0	3.3	1.0	-8.8	2.6	19.0	11.0	15.2
2022	-22.6	-0.3	25.3	-18.1	-25.2	-31.7	21.8	-11.4	-2.1	7.2	-18.0	-4.5
2021	33.9	39.6	31.1	11.4	-25.7	-5.9	12.5	25.2	-9.9	42.9	-1.0	-15.0

Source: CoinGecko
As of March 31, 2025

Figure 2: Monthly price performance of the top 10 coins by market capitalization



Source: CoinMarketCap
As of March 31, 2025

In descending order of performance:

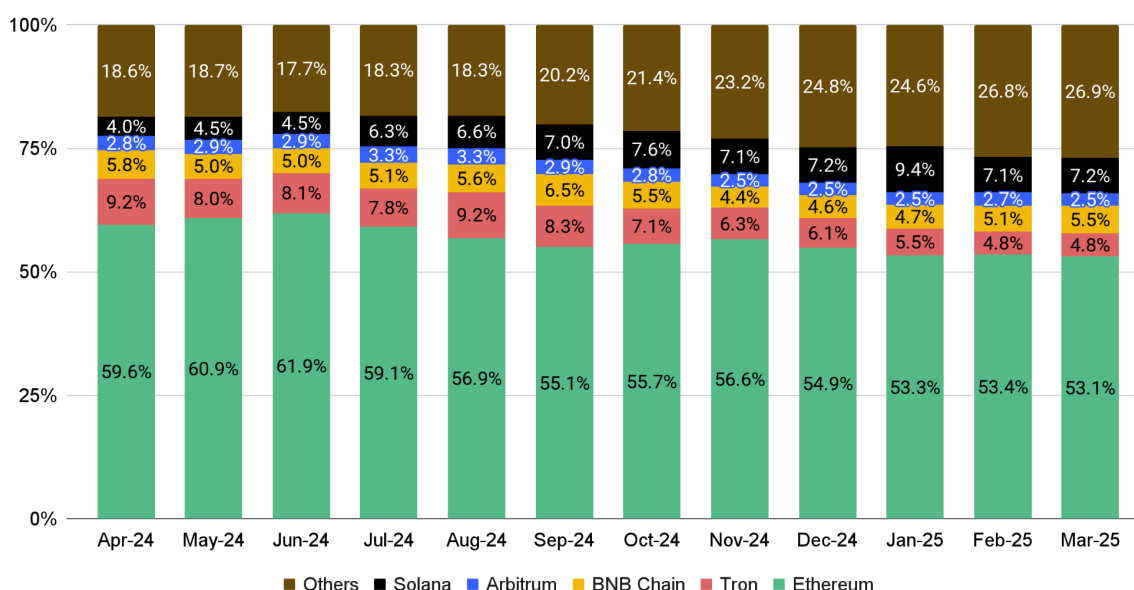
- ◆ In March, TON surged 17.1%, following a disclosure by the TON Foundation that over US\$400M in Toncoin had been purchased from early investors by blockchain focused venture capital firms including Sequoia, Ribbit, and Benchmark. This came alongside a significant rise in native accounts, growing from 4 million to 41 million over the past year.
- ◆ A key driver behind ADA's 4.4% incline was its consideration for inclusion in the U.S. Digital Asset Stockpile. Following the announcement, ADA briefly rallied by over 70%. Meanwhile, its DeFi ecosystem also expanded further, with the stablecoin market capitalization surpassing US\$30M in March.
- ◆ BNB rose by 2.5% in March. Notably, the World Liberty Financial project launched its USD1 stablecoin on the BNB Chain. Additionally, BNB Chain surpassed Solana in daily decentralized exchange (DEX) trading volume on several days in March, driven largely by the growing popularity of meme coins within its ecosystem. This high level of activity on BNB Chain, which requires BNB for gas fees, likely contributed to increased demand. To further support the ecosystem, BNB Chain announced a substantial US\$100M Permanent Liquidity Support Program aimed at enhancing the liquidity of native tokens listed on centralized exchanges (CEXes).
- ◆ XRP fell by 0.4% in March as investors continue to be torn between new industry partnerships and the lingering litigious uncertainty. Ripple announced a collaboration with Chipper Cash, a leading provider of mobile payment services operating across nine African countries and serving millions of users. This partnership aims to enhance Ripple Payments, using XRP for faster, cheaper, and more efficient cross-border transactions into Africa. Meanwhile, anticipation continues to build around the resolution of the U.S. SEC lawsuit against Ripple Labs.
- ◆ TRX fell by -0.8%. A key highlight for Tron in March 2025 was its continued dominance in USDT transfers. Data from IntoTheBlock revealed that Tron held an impressive 78% of cumulative USDT addresses, underscoring the network's pivotal

role in providing a cost-effective and seamless environment for stablecoin transactions globally.

- ◆ BTC fell by 2.4% in March, despite U.S. President Trump signing an Executive Order to establish a Strategic Bitcoin Reserve and a Digital Asset Stockpile composed of various cryptocurrencies. Investors likely expected the reserve to consist of BTC purchased by the U.S. government rather than being funded by BTC forfeited to the U.S. Treasury through criminal or civil proceedings. However, the order also leaves room for budget-neutral strategies to acquire additional BTC in the future.
- ◆ SOL declined by 15.8%, in March 2025. Throughout early March, the Solana network continued to face severe congestion, largely driven by the surge in trading activity surrounding the launch and rising popularity of various memecoins. A key indicator of these issues was a reported 80% drop in Solana's monthly revenue for March. This sharp decline was accompanied by significant reductions in key on-chain metrics, including a 21% decrease in active addresses, an 82% plunge in the number of transactions, and an 81% drop in total fees generated on the network.
- ◆ ETH fell by 19.3%, amid growing concerns over the rising prominence and adoption of Layer 2 (L2) scaling solutions. Some in the market view this trend as potentially diverting value and activity away from Ethereum's main Layer 1 (L1), leading to reduced demand for ETH, which is used to pay gas fees.

2.1 Decentralized Finance (DeFi)

Figure 3: TVL share of top blockchains



Source: DeFiLlama
As of March 31, 2025

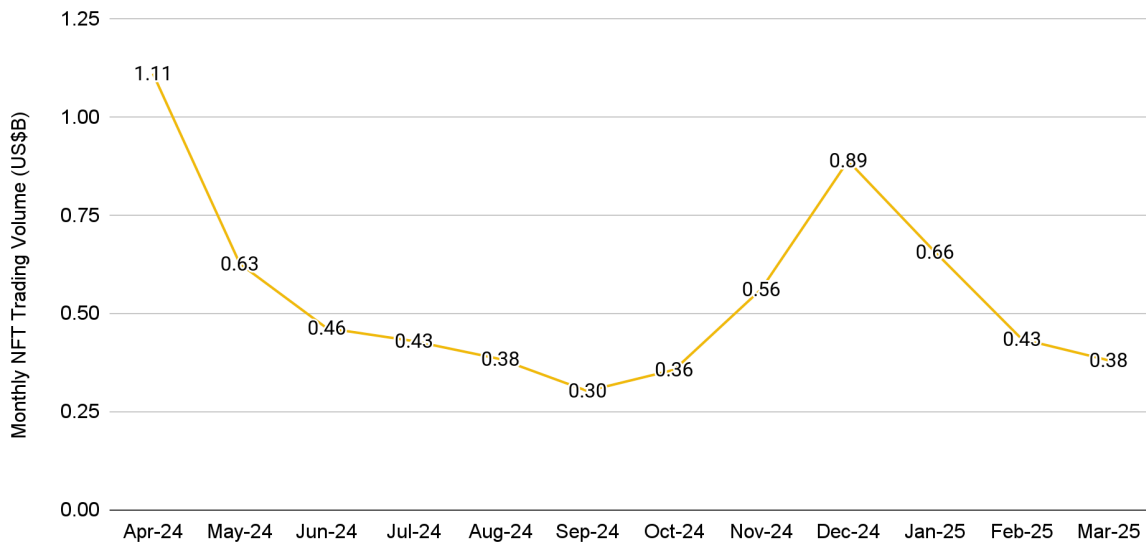
In March 2025, DeFi Total Value Locked (TVL) dropped 1.5% month-on-month (MoM). This follows the U.S. Senate's March 4 resolution to overturn the IRS's DeFi Broker Rule that classified DeFi platform operators as brokers. The rule would have imposed heavy reporting requirements on DeFi platforms, stifling innovation and raising privacy concerns. The repeal, supported by both Congress and President Trump's administration, used the Congressional Review Act to block the IRS from reissuing a similar rule without explicit congressional approval, marking a significant win for the DeFi sector.

Building on February's momentum, the stablecoin market cap increased by 4.4%, further supported by progress on the GENIUS Act, which aims to regulate stablecoin payments for the first time. Permitted issuers must meet strict financial conditions and maintain reserves on a 1:1 basis. Notably, USDC has outpaced USDT's growth, with its market share rising from 20% to 25.7%. USDC also stands out as the only stablecoin in compliance with new EU regulations.

Among the top five DeFi ecosystems, BNB Chain was the only one to register TVL growth in March. This was supported by elevated trading on PancakeSwap, largely driven by memecoin activity, as well as Token Generation Event (TGE) partnerships with Binance Wallet, and token swap rewards.

2.2 Non-Fungible Tokens (NFTs)

Figure 4: Monthly NFT trading volume



Source: CryptoSlam
As of March 31, 2025

In March 2025, the NFT market declined sharply, with total sales volume dropping 12.4% across the top 10 chains, with Immutable and Panini being exceptions. The number of unique buyers hit its lowest level since October 2023, reflecting a slowdown in demand driven by macroeconomic uncertainty.

Ethereum-based NFT sales plummeted 59.3%, with Crypto Punks as the only top-20 collection to record growth. Bored Ape Yacht Club and Pudgy Penguins saw sales fall by over 50%, while Panini's America NFTs surged 259.2%, solidifying its place among the top 10 NFT chains. With a 60-year history in collectibles, Panini's move into NFTs offers blockchain-verified digital assets, ensuring authenticity and exclusivity.

Despite the downturn, real-world partnerships signal ongoing interest in NFTs. Azuki teamed up with toy designer Michael Lau for a physical-backed NFT, The Sandbox partnered with Jurassic World to bring dinosaurs to the metaverse, EGGCRYPTO collaborated with anime series Eparida on limited-edition characters, and Sony's Soneium platform joined forces with LINE to develop Web3 mini-apps.

03 / Charts of the Month

BTC Long-Term Holders Have Resumed Accumulation

Figure 5: After bottoming in February this year, the supply of BTC held by long term holders is once again on the rise



Source: Glassnode, Binance Research (See [how Glassnode quantifies long-term holders](#))
As of March 31, 2025

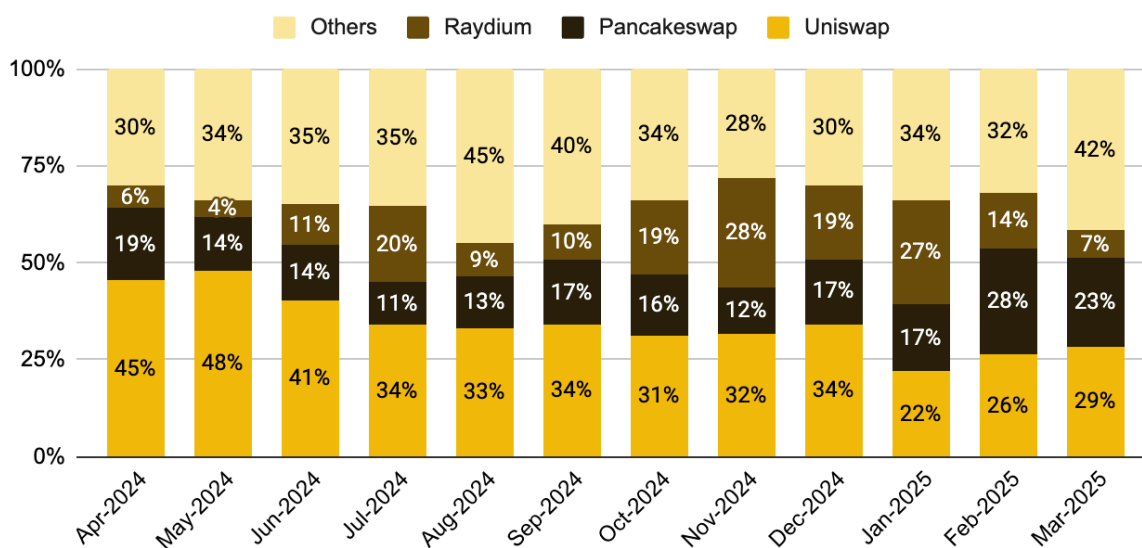
Following a peak in December 2023 and a lower high in September 2024, the supply of BTC held by long-term holders (wallets with an average purchasing date exceeding 155 days) bottomed in February 2025 and is now rising again. This accumulation by HODLers aligns with a significant period of adoption for Bitcoin, marked by the establishment of a **U.S. strategic Bitcoin and crypto reserve** and widespread reports of companies and governments **purchasing Bitcoin for their own reserves**.

In addition to solidifying its position as a widely recognized wealth-preserving asset, the Bitcoin on-chain ecosystem has shown steady progress. Our recent report, titled **The Future of Bitcoin #4: DeFi** highlights that Bitcoin DeFi (BTCFi) has become one of the fastest-growing sectors, with total value locked (TVL) surging by 2,767%, from US\$0.3B to US\$8.6B over the past year.

These developments, alongside the potential for further interest rate cuts by the Fed, have contributed to a more optimistic sentiment toward Bitcoin's medium and long-term prospects.

The DEX Landscape is Evolving

Figure 6: PancakeSwap and Raydium are capturing an increasingly larger portion of the trading volume market share



Source: The Block, Binance Research
As of March 31, 2025

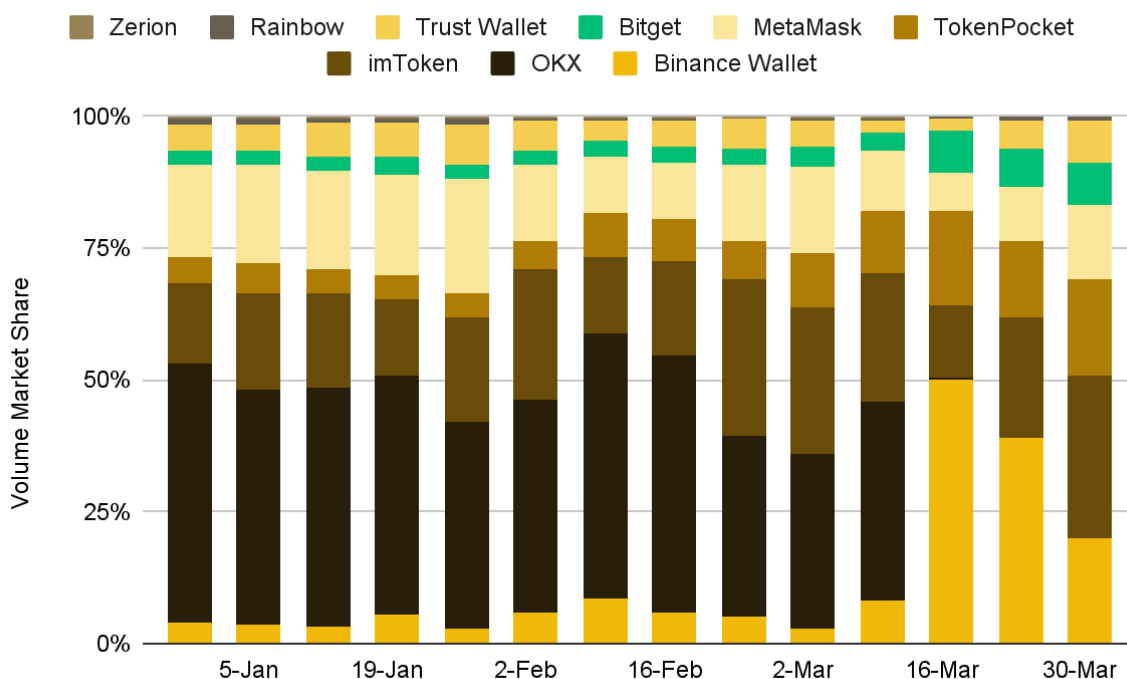
Uniswap, which has traditionally held the position of the leading DEX, has experienced a steady decline in its share of trading volume, dropping from 45% last year to 29% as of March 2025 due to the intensified competition in the DEX landscape. This decline is also reflected by the number of active traders on Uniswap within the Ethereum network, which has decreased by over 46% since the beginning of 2025, falling from approximately 69,700 to 37,300.

Notably, trading volume of PancakeSwap surpassed that of Uniswap in February 2025, with the former capturing a 28% market share compared to Uniswap's 26%. This shift has been attributed to elevated memecoin trading activity on BNB Chain, as well as recent programs introduced to support ecosystem activity. For instance, BNB Chain recently announced a US\$100M liquidity incentive program for tokens on BSC that achieve certain centralized exchange (CEX) listings. Additionally, BNB Chain implemented the Pascal Hardfork recently, which improved EVM compatibility, and introduced gas abstraction as well as smart contract wallets, among other upgrades.

Raydium has also emerged as a strong contender in the DEX space since late last year, driven by the Solana memecoin frenzy. However, its market share has slightly declined in recent months as tokens that graduated from pump.fun are now migrated to pump.fun's native DEX, PumpSwap, instead of Raydium. Since its launch on March 20, PumpSwap has grown rapidly, facilitating nearly US\$3B in trading volume. While Raydium still maintains a significant lead and is widely used within the Solana ecosystem, PumpSwap's rapid growth proves itself a formidable competitor to watch in the memecoin trading space.

Major Shifts in the Wallet Landscape

Figure 7: Amid major shifts in the competitive wallet landscape, Binance Wallet captured over 50% of total swap volume in mid-March



Source: Dune Analytics (@lz_web3), Binance Research
As of March 31, 2025

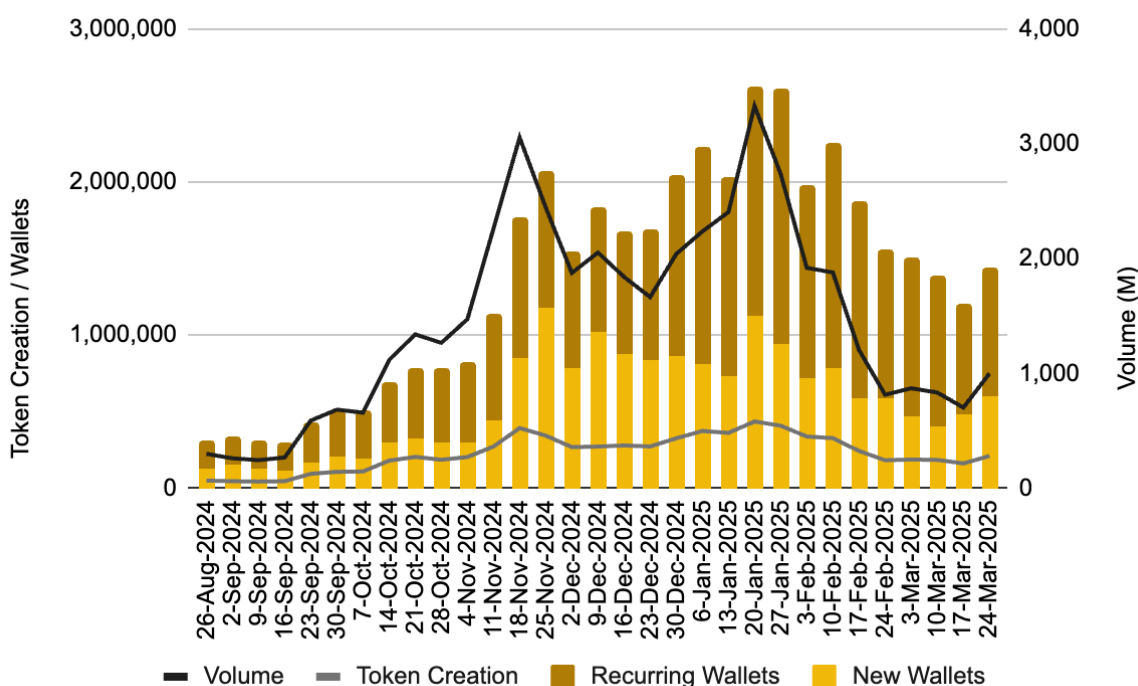
March brought major shifts in the Web3 wallet landscape. Binance Wallet, which accounted for less than 5% of swap volume at the start of the year, saw a sharp rise, surpassing 50% market share in mid-March. This occurred while other wallet providers maintained relatively stable volumes in the same period.

This shift followed OKX's temporary suspension of its DEX aggregator services, which had previously driven significant activity through its wallet. With no official timeline for service restoration, a wave of user migration appears to have taken place, with Binance Wallet emerging as one of the biggest beneficiaries. In the week of the announcement, Binance Wallet recorded ~US\$351.7M in swap volumes, up from ~US\$43.6M the previous week.

While this served as an immediate catalyst, Binance Wallet had already been experiencing increased user activity. This trend aligned with broader DEX growth on BNB Chain — particularly via PancakeSwap — and was supported by platform-level incentives, including zero-fee trading, token swap rewards, and the rollout of new features such as Alpha 2.0 and a Token Generation Event (TGE) program. Together, these factors contributed to the surge in wallet usage observed in March.

Memecoins May Have Topped

Figure 8: Pump.fun usage metrics have been on the decline since the launch of \$TRUMP



Source: Dune Analytics (@adamtehc), Binance Research
As of March 31, 2025

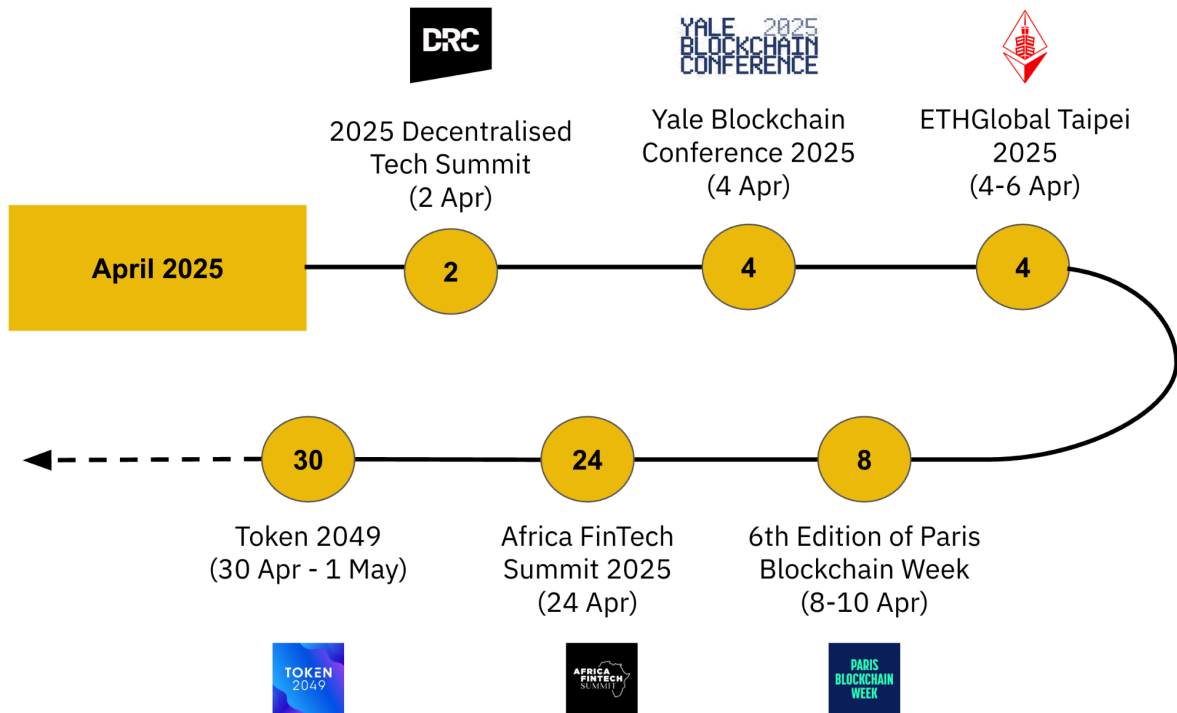
Pump.fun has been synonymous with the “memecoin supercycle”, enabling easy and cheap token creation for just 0.02 SOL, and accounts for over 70% of the token launches on Solana today. Notable memecoins that graduated from pump.fun and scaled to billion dollar valuations include Moo Deng, Goatseus Maximus, Peanut the Squirrel, Fartcoin etc.

However, since the launch of \$TRUMP, weekly usage metrics for pump.fun have been declining across the board. Total volume, total token creation and total active wallets all peaked during the week of 20 January 2025 at US\$33.3B, 435.6K and 2.85M respectively. These same metrics stand at US\$1B, 209.8K and 1.44M as of 31 March 2025, a decline of 69.9%, 51.8% and 45.1% respectively.

Despite the declining metrics, tokens like DOGE and SHIB remain among the top 20 cryptocurrencies by market cap, and recent ETF filing applications for DOGE, BONK, and TRUMP indicate that interest in the sector persists, albeit with increased focus on more recognizable or established assets.

04 / Upcoming Events and Token Unlocks

Figure 9: Notable Events in April 2025



Source: Cryptoevents, Binance Research

Figure 10: Largest token unlocks in US\$ terms

PROJECT	TOKEN	UNLOCK IN US\$ EQUIVALENT	% OF SUPPLY	UNLOCK DATE
	TRUMP	420M	20.00%	18 Apr
	SUI	206M	2.52%	01 Apr
	CIRX	148M	99.10%	12 Apr
	APT	63M	1.87%	12 Apr
	ENA	37M	1.78%	02 Apr
	AXS	34M	6.71%	12 Apr
	ARB	33M	2.01%	16 Apr
	JTO	26M	3.66%	07 Apr
	RON	24M	5.28%	27 Apr
	MOVE	24M	2.07%	09 Apr

Source: CryptoRank, Binance Research

05 / References

defillama.com/
coinmarketcap.com/
cryptoslam.io/
token.unlocks.app/
dune.com/
itez.com/events
cryptorank.io/

06 / New Binance Research Reports

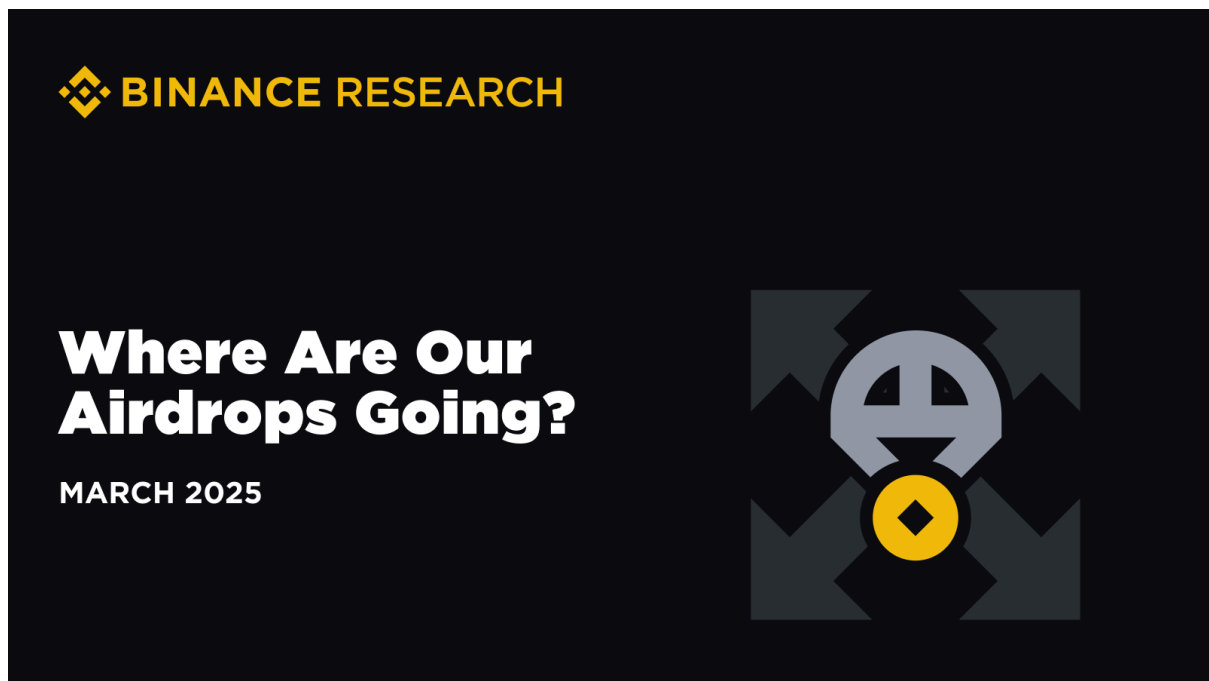
Navigating Crypto: Industry Map [Link](#)

An overview of different verticals in crypto



Where Are Our Airdrops Going: [Link](#)

A deep dive into airdrop mechanics and how we can improve them



About Binance Research

Binance Research is the research arm of Binance, the world's leading cryptocurrency exchange. The team is committed to delivering objective, independent, and comprehensive analysis and aims to be the thought leader in the crypto space. Our analysts publish insightful thought pieces regularly on topics related but not limited to, the crypto ecosystem, blockchain technologies, and the latest market themes.



Jie Xuan Chua
Macro Research Lead

Jie Xuan (JX) is currently the Macro Research Lead at Binance. Prior to joining Binance, he worked as a Global Investment Specialist with J.P. Morgan and had prior Equity Research experiences at various fund houses. JX is a CFA charterholder. He has been involved in the cryptocurrency space since 2017.



Joshua Wong
Macro Researcher

Joshua is currently working for Binance as a Macro Researcher. He has been involved in the cryptocurrency space since 2019. Prior to joining Binance, he worked as a product manager at a Web3 fintech startup, and a market analyst at a DeFi startup. He holds a Bachelor of Laws (LLB) from Durham University.



Moulik Nagesh
Macro Researcher

Moulik is a Macro Researcher at Binance, and he has been involved in the cryptocurrency space since 2017. Prior to joining Binance, he had experience spanning cross-functional roles in Web3- and Silicon Valley-based tech companies. With a background in co-founding start-ups and a BSc in Economics from the London School of Economics & Political Science ("LSE"), Moulik brings a comprehensive perspective to the industry.



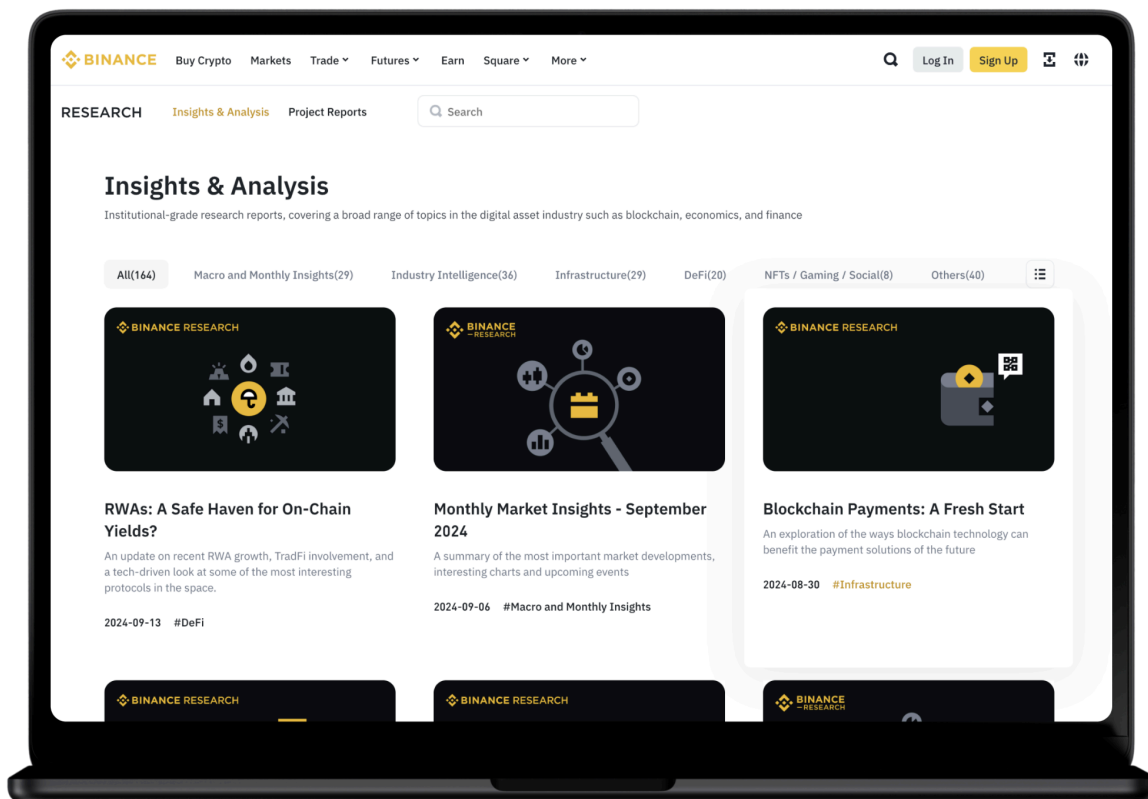
Jamyson Gouveros

Macro Research Intern

Jamyson is currently working for Binance as a Macro Research Analyst intern. Prior to joining Binance, he worked as a Venture Capital Analyst, and later, a pre-seed investor. He is a sophomore at the University of New South Wales ("UNSW") and has been involved in the cryptocurrency space since 2021 after founding a Tokenisation start-up.

Resources

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